January: An election is held in Sikkim. The anti-palace opposition claims it is rigged, the opposition against the local ruler, the chogyal, gains momentum.

1974

18 May: India tests a nuclear device.

4 September: Sikkim becomes an Indian ‘associate state’.

1975

16 May: Sikkim becomes India’s 22nd state after the chogyal is deposed and a referendum is held.

1976

9 September: Mao Zedong dies. A power struggle ensues which ends with Deng Xiaoping’s return to power.

1979

April: A movement, which became known as ‘the Assam Agitation’, begins in Assam against illegal immigrants. The more militant activists form the United Liberation Front of Asom (Assam).

1983

18 February: More than 2,000 people are killed in Nellie in Assam when mobs attack villages inhabited by Muslims. The violence was seen as a fallout of the decision to hold state elections in 1983 in the midst of the ‘Assam Agitation’, and after Indira Gandhi’s decision to give four million migrants from Bangladesh the right to vote.

1986

30 June: The Government of India and the Mizo National Front sign an accord, paving the way for Mizoram to become a fully fledged state within the Indian Union.

October: The Indian Army launches ‘Operation Falcon’ to secure the border between Zeimithang in India and Khenzemane on the Tibet-China side.